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Motherboard Test



ASRock A75M-ITX

generation Core i5-2500K for the benchmarks. Naturally, its scores will be lower as compared to 3rd gen processors. Other H61 boards worked fine with the Core i7-3770K after a BIOS update.

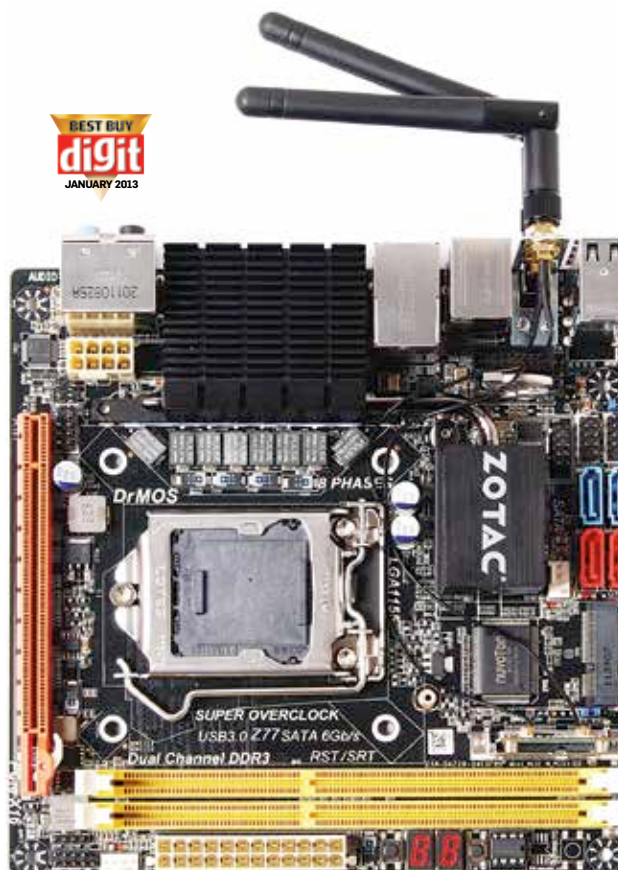
Verdict

We decided to divide the boards according to the chipsets on which they were based to be fair to all participants. Among the A75 boards, there was a close fight in terms of value for money between the two boards. The ZOTAC A75-ITX has a huge advantage in the form of an on-board Wi-Fi connector, but its available for ₹1,200 more than the ASRock A75M-ITX. Thousand rupees is a huge price gap when you are considering buying mini ITX boards. Hence, the **ASRock A75M-ITX** was awarded the **Best Buy**.

The H61 boards had a close fight between Intel, MSI and Foxconn but **Foxconn H61S** was awarded the **Best Buy**

award for its economical pricing. For an H61 board, the

Foxconn board provides ample features including a PCIe x16 slot which was lacking in the MSI and Intel boards. The



ZOTAC Z77ITX-A-E

Media Boards

We also got two Media boards from Intel, namely DH61AG and DQ77KB which are different from the other boards in the sense that these media boards come with a unique 1x2-pin power connector on the board and there is a power connector on the back panel I/O that will take 19 Volts from a power adapter. Both the boards have a very slim form factor with the backpanel I/O under 2cm height. Of course finding a cooler that slim is an arduous task. Both the boards come with a full-size and half-size mini PCI express connectors for adding a Wi-Fi card or an mSATA SSD. They have SO-DIMM slots and one PCIe x4 slot. As far as backpanel I/O ports go, the DH61AG supports DVI, HDMI, two USB 3.0 ports, two USB 2.0 ports (which can also be used for device charging) and a single LAN port. The DQ77KB includes an HDMI and a DisplayPort alongwith two LAN ports and four USB ports. The DQ77KB is the more feature rich of the two and is priced accordingly at ₹7,888 whereas the DH61AG comes for ₹6,670. These boards are ideal for those looking to build a slim HTPC, but it will depend a lot on availability of a compatible mini ITX case, the 19V power supply and a slim cooler.

ASUS board has the larger overall score, but it is also priced the highest.

Among the H77 boards, Gigabyte and ASUS had a close fight with the overall score difference of just over two points. Gigabyte has an advantage with the on-board Wi-Fi module, but the pricing is way off the charts. At almost ₹2,500 over the ASUS board, it just makes **ASUS P8H77-I** the **Best Buy**.

Finally, in the high-end mini ITX category, we had three wonderful boards battling it out. **ASUS P8Z77-I Deluxe** bagged the **Editor's Pick** award for its highest overall score, a killer feature set and an innovation that was not seen on any other mini-ITX board we have tested to date. The overclocking prowess of the ASUS board is way better than that of the ASRock and ZOTAC Z77 boards. **ZOTAC Z77-ITX A-E** was awarded the **Best Buy** for its bang-for-the-buck offerings and a very sweet pricing.